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Culture (OWC): [Khoi \(FX13\)](#)

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Section Title(S): 2. Intra-Family Relationships

If it concerns the parents of a third person, the term used is usually /(e)ĩb di //gũb (respectively -s) or /(e)ĩb di ĩb (respectively -s), i.e. his father (respectively his mother).

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Kinship Terminology

Without breaking the above-mentioned rules, the following expressions that I also heard frequently are correct: sa //gũb, sa ĩb, thy father and correspondingly thy mother. Further I heard (e)ĩb di dāb(ais), his father (his mother).

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Kinship Terminology

The stepmother is *õ!gã //gũs, i.e. "the mother who stands behind the one who bore the child."

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Kinship Terminology

The designation *abo 'b for the father I found only in the language of the folktales, never in conversation.

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Kinship Terminology

c) I noticed a great variety of addresses used between siblings. At first I thought I was hearing terms of endearment or teasing names. But when I sought to determine their meaning, I came upon rigid norms which indicate the Hottentots' strong sense of age rank even within the sibling circle (!gãb, -s, -n = brother, sister, siblings); it is the exclusive privilege of the older siblings to call the younger ones by name. The younger siblings designate the oldest sister, the person who commands the most respect among the siblings, as

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Age Stratification

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Kinship Terminology

*ausis (3. f.), when speaking to her or about her. The next oldest one or ones are called *sirō's (3. st.). The younger siblings address the oldest brother as *a'budib. The next oldest one or ones are called *bi'dirob.

d) I have been able to find out the least about the in-law relationships. The relationship of the four in-laws to their married children is the same in address as it is between parents and children; they use the second person singular. The in-laws are called /uɔi'b and /uɔi's in the third person.

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Kinship Terminology

The wife is called *loaras in address by her husband's relatives or when she is spoken about in the third person. By all the feminine relatives of her husband, with the exception of her mother-in-law, without consideration for differences in age, she is called xaë's.

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Kinship Terminology

/u'ɔiaob means brother-in-law. In the word /u'ɔigukxa, that is used to designate two brothers-in-law, the reciprocal particle, -gu, seems to express the equality of rank between the two in relation to each other and the onesided relationship of respect for the parents-in-law.

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Kinship Terminology

Some light on the position of the brother-in-law in the family is shed by the phrase with which the Hottentot occasionally appeases a whirlwind: "/uɔiaob //goë!" Just as one does not make the children cry in the presence of the brother-in-law by spanking them and does  104 not quarrel, but behaves properly, so the wind is warned not to throw the objects around so wildly that it has seized: "The brother-in-law is there!"

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Avoidance And Taboo

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Magic

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